


*(From left)* **Raj Chengappa,** *Editorial Director, India Today;* **Nigar Shaji**, *Project Director, Aditya L1 solar mission, Indian Space Research Organisation;* **Prof. Annapurni Subramaniam**, *Director, Indian Institute of Astrophysics*

# THE EQUITY QUEST

## THE INDIA TODAY WOMAN SUMMIT CELEBRATED SHEROES ACROSS DIVERSE FIELDS, WHO CHAMPION GENDER EQUITY AND EMPOWERMENT

By *Suhani Singh*

**There was no room for mansplaining** at the INDIA TODAY Woman Summit–Gender Equity held in Chennai on February 9. Instead, it was all about leading women across fields sharing their experiences of overcoming odds and lessons learnt along the way. The audience—young and predominantly female—bore witness to the testimonies of sheroes in the arts (Carnatic vocalist Aruna Sairam, Bharatanatyam dancer Narthaki Nataraj and actress Pooja Hedge); in science and medicine (Suchitra Ella of Bharat Biotech, Nigar Shaji from the Indian Space Research Organisation, Prof. Annapurni Subramaniam, director, Indian Institute of Astrophysics and Dr Pratima Murthy, director, National Institute of Mental Health and Neuro Sciences); and in business (Saundarya Rajesh, founder-president of the Avtar Group; Lavanya Nalli, vice chairperson of the Nalli Group of Companies; Dr Urjitha Rajagopalan, director, MGM Healthcare; Megha Asher, co-founder of beauty label Juicy Chemistry; and Nalini Parthiban, co-founder of Sweet Karam Coffee).

India Today Group's Editorial Director Raj Chengappa noted that for India to progress, it is imperative that it be "a leader in gender equity and equality". He identified five areas where work needs to be done—workforce participation and pay parity; education and empowerment; healthcare disparities; legal